

Freshman Alumni Bot

A guide for group leaders · @freshmanalumni_bot · two steps, about a minute, no commands to remember.

1 Add the bot to your group — this is the whole setup

- 1 In the group: **Members** → **Add member** → @freshmanalumni_bot.
- 2 Promote it to **Administrator**, and turn on **Pin messages**.
- 3 Repeat in each group you want it working in. Every group is handled independently and gets its own announcement — you choose which ones, and you can add more whenever you like.

That's it. Promoting it is the switch-on.

The bot enrolls the group by itself, then posts and pins the join announcement **within the hour**. You don't run a command, you don't send anyone an ID, and nobody has to change a setting on our side to add your group. If you'd rather not wait for the announcement to appear, ask the core team to trigger it.

2 Why Administrator matters

Admin rights are not a formality — the bot is inert without them. Telegram only tells a bot who joins a group if it is an administrator, and pinning needs the **Pin messages** right specifically. If you add the bot as an ordinary member, nothing happens at all: no enrolment, no announcement, no error. **That is the single most common reason a group looks broken.**

3 What the bot puts in your group

Exactly two things ever appear in the group chat:

- 1 **The pinned announcement** — two buttons, *Join the Alumni group* and *I'm already in it*. It re-posts itself every five days and deletes the previous one, so only one is ever live.
- 2 **A follow-up message** naming the people who still haven't tapped either button, sent a few days after the announcement.

Everything else is a private DM. Nobody is tagged in the group for not having joined, and nobody is corrected in front of everyone. You can tell your members that safely.

4 What a member goes through

So you can answer “what is this bot?” without asking us: they tap **Join the Alumni group**, which opens the bot in a private chat. There it asks them to fill in a short form, read the values doc, and send a 50–100 word intro. Once all three are done it hands them a personal one-time invite link and they're admitted automatically. Tapping **I'm already in it** is checked against the real group, so it can't be used to skip the process.

5 If something looks wrong

No announcement, an hour later	Nine times out of ten the bot is a member but not an Administrator . Check that first; otherwise tell us and we'll look at whether the gate is switched on.
It isn't pinned	The bot has admin rights but not Pin messages . The announcement still works unpinned.
“But I <i>am</i> in the group!”	Almost always a second Telegram account. Ask which account they use in the alumni group, and have them open the bot from that one.
“The bot won't reply to me”	They need to tap Start in the private chat once. Telegram won't let a bot message anyone who hasn't.
Anything else	Message @gapyearingdoesntsuck.

The core team also has `/gate_stats`, `/gate_groups`, `/gate_list`, `/gate_announce` and `/gate_unwatch`. Those check an internal admin list first and stay silent for everyone else, so if you type one and nothing happens, that's why — ask @gapyearingdoesntsuck rather than retrying.